COURSE OUTLINE

ES5000 provides an opportunity for you to explore academic English and the communication skills you will need to be a successful graduate student at NUS in the age of generative AI. You will develop your foundational academic English language reading, writing and speaking skills so that you can increase your confidence and successfully integrate into your discipline-specific academic community.

Course Learning Outcomes

Upon successful completion of this course, students should be able to

- Evaluate and use academic English accurately and appropriately in various contexts
- Analyze the purpose, organizational patterns and language features of a variety of academic texts
- Write well-structured paragraphs and essays using specific organisational strategies
- Integrate ideas from published sources appropriately into written and spoken academic texts

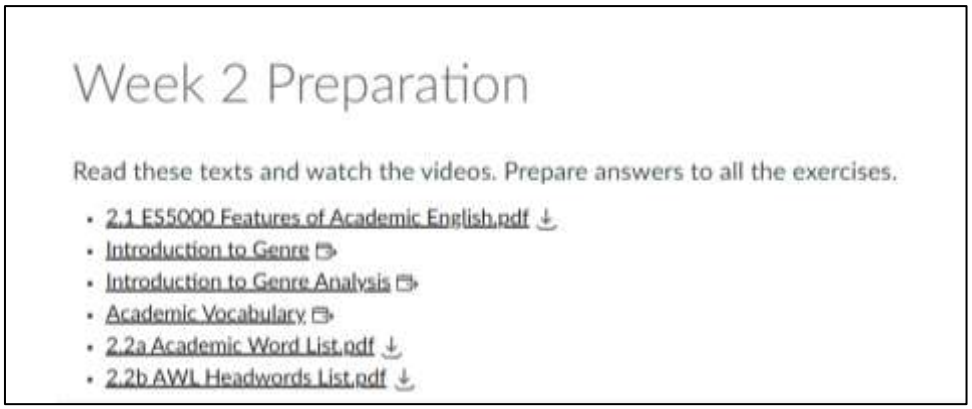
Learning Approach

ES5000 has adopted a blended learning format, including both online learning and in-person tutorials. It is very important that you visit the ES5000 Canvas site before each week's tutorial to prepare for class. Each week's module description includes a preparation section, a topics section and a wrap up section.



The Preparation section provides links to readings, videos and various exercises that you should prepare *before* you come to that week's tutorial lesson. The Topics section lists the topics we will discuss *in class* that week, and the Wrap Up section gives reminders, advice or supplementary resources on that week's topics.

For example, before you come to class for your first tutorial, you should prepare for the lesson by clicking on *Week 2 Preparation*, where will see the following:



Thus, for Week 2, you should download, read and complete all the exercises in *2.1 ES5000 Features of Academic English*. You should view the videos about Genre Analysis and read the information provided in the links about Academic Vocabulary.

You will find similar materials in each week's Preparation section. As most course materials will be provided in soft copy through Canvas, **you should plan to bring a laptop or tablet computer to each lesson**. Using a mobile phone for this purpose is strongly discouraged as the screen is too small to complete the exercises found in the handouts.

Throughout the semester we will use class time for mini-lectures, discussions, student-teacher conferences, writing workshops, and reviewing independent and/or collaborative learning exercises. The pedagogical approaches employed include task-based learning, lexico-grammatical analysis, and genre analysis. These approaches will provide you with hands-on practice with authentic language materials while encouraging the development of an awareness of issues pertaining to communication at the graduate level.

Recommended References

Binder, C. A. & Lopez-Nerney, S. (2008). *Writing in process: Strategies for organization and development* (3rd ed.). Pearson Prentice Hall.

Cain, J. S. (2003). *Eye on editing 2: Developing editing skills for writing*. Longman.

Lane, J. & Lange, E. (1999). *Writing clearly: An editing guide (*2nd ed.). Heinle & Heinle Publishers.

Raimes, A. (2004). *Grammar Troublespots: A guide for student writers* (3rd ed.). Cambridge University Press.

Course Assessment

This is a 100% Continuous Assessment (CA) course, and the final course grade will be comprised of the following:

- Cause and Effect Paragraphs 20%
- Problem-Solution Essay 1 20%
- Problem-Solution Essay 2 10%
- Oral Presentation 20%
- Online Grammar Quizzes 10%
- Class Interaction* 20%

**Class interaction consists of various ungraded writing tasks and students' preparedness for as well as contribution to online and in-class activities.*

To pass this course, students must obtain at least a C grade while students from Yong Loo Lin School of Medicine must obtain a C+.

Expectations

To optimize your learning experience, you should

- Prepare for class by completing all assigned tasks before the weekly face-to-face lessons (e.g., read handouts, view videos and complete practice exercises).
- Attend all classes on time and participate actively in class discussions and activities.
- Show respect for the contributions of other students and help to create a conducive learning environment.
- Submit assignments on time and ensure your work represents your best effort. There will be a 10% penalty for work submitted late and a 10% penalty for submissions which exceed the word limit for that assignment.
- Avoid scheduling trips and conference presentations during the semester as attendance and participation will affect your grade.

Workload

The following is a suggested workload schedule for ES5000, a total of 8 hours per week:

- 3 hours/week: attending tutorials
- 2 hours/week: preparing for tutorials, for example, reading handouts, watching videos and completing practice exercises
- 2 hours/week: completing writing assignments, preparing for the presentation and completing grammar quizzes
- 1 hour/week: revising lessons learnt

Academic Honesty

Students at the National University of Singapore are expected to uphold academic integrity and submit their original work. To avoid plagiarism, students must acknowledge the use of borrowed information by citing their sources. Students who commit or attempt to commit, or cause or attempt to cause any other person to commit any of the following offences may be subject to disciplinary proceedings according to NUS Statute 6, Clause 3(l):

> "Plagiarism, giving or receiving unauthorised assistance in academic work, or other forms of academic dishonesty."

For more information, please refer to:

https://www.nus.edu.sg/registrar/docs/info/administrative-policies-procedures/statute06.pdf

Plagiarism (including self-plagiarism) is a serious offence. According to the NUS Plagiarism Policy, academic units will impose sanctions against students who plagiarise work at a 'minor', 'moderate', or 'serious' level.

For more information, please refer to:

https://www.nus.edu.sg/registrar/docs/info/administrative-policies-procedures/Regn10.pdf

https://myportal.nus.edu.sg/studentportal/student-discipline/all/docs/NUS-Plagiarism-Policy.pdf.

Students are expected to complete THE1002/SE1000, the e-module called Student Essentials. The completion of this e-module is **compulsory for all incoming students**.

The deadline is **4 weeks from the date of the completion of your NUS Student Registration (Part One)**. If you do not complete this e-module, you will be assigned a "Hold" status to your student account, which will block the following services:

- View/print Student Status Letter
- View/print Unofficial Transcript

The above services are required for applications to programmes like student exchanges and internships amongst others.

For additional information about academic integrity, please visit the Library guide:

https://libguides.nus.edu.sg/new2nus/acadintegrity

Guidelines on the Use of AI Tools for Academic Work

Artificial Intelligence tools such as ChatGPT are now essentially costless and do not require special expertise to use. As part of the repertoire of tools available in the modern world, we understand how you – our students – might be drawn to using them. It is also likely employers and stakeholders will soon assume that graduates have a basic competency for using such tools, just as they now assume that new hires are able to use calculators, spreadsheets, and word processing software. That said, there are some things we need you to take to heart.

First, while we are fine with your experimenting with new tools, we are also wary you will end up taking shortcuts that will disadvantage you in the long run. Consider, for instance, the different levels of capability involved in the following three scenarios:

1) Using a tool to generate an output wholesale from inputs.
2) Using a tool to generate intermediate outputs that are then developed into a final output through further human intervention without the use of the tool.
3) Evaluating the output of a tool to confirm its accuracy, relevance, objectivity, and completeness.

You will need a higher level of capability to be able to do (2) and (3), as compared with (1), and conversely, functions that only require (1) are at a higher risk of being completely replaced by AI. The implication is that you are only cheating your future selves if you go straight to using such tools before learning the actual subject matter. If you, as a learner, take shortcuts today, you risk becoming first in line to be replaced by bots tomorrow.

Since we target learning outcomes that hone higher level capabilities, and we want our students to demonstrate originality, voice, intellectual engagement with content, rigor, and contribution to discourse, we will often need you to produce unaided work as part of your assessment. This is no different from how, even though we expect you to use calculators and spreadsheets, we still want you to learn the underlying math and computational processes. And even though we are fine with you using search engines, spelling and grammar checkers, or for that matter, lexicons and thesauri, we still want you to be able to independently organize your thoughts and produce your own compositions – so that you can assess the texts AI tools can produce.

Second, note that normal academic rules continue to apply. As provided in the Code of Student Conduct (https://www.nus.edu.sg/campusconduct/),

> The University takes a strict view of cheating in any form, deceptive fabrication, plagiarism and violation of intellectual property and copyright laws. Any student who is found to have engaged in such misconduct will be subject to disciplinary action by the University.

Given the above, representing an AI's output as your own work, without any acknowledgement that you have used such a tool, is plagiarism.

Third, do be aware that most AI tools require you to sign up for an account and accept various terms and conditions. We encourage you to be very clear about what you are accepting if you sign up for an account. You should also be aware that there are lawsuits underway challenging the intellectual property provenance of many of these tools. If they are ruled illegal (while this is unlikely, it is not impossible), there may be implications for your use as well. And finally, don't forget that like all online tools, platforms can sometimes go down without warning, or are under such high load that their responses become too slow for use. It is thus unwise to assume that you will always have access.

All in all, we hope that you will be thoughtful about how you can advance your learning and make the most of your university education.

Accessibility Support and Accommodations

If you anticipate or experience physical or academic barriers due to a disability and/or accessibility needs, you are welcome to let your lecturer know so that we can discuss options available to you. You are also encouraged to contact the **Student Accessibility Unit** (accessibility@nus.edu.sg) to find out more about reasonable accommodations that may be available and useful for you.